

The Monkeys go a Fasting

A group of monkeys decided to go on a **fast** one day.

"Before we begin, I think we should keep the food with which we'll break the fast ready," **counselled** the old monkey chief.

The monkeys **nodded their heads in agreement**. The youngsters were sent in search of food. They returned with huge hands of delicious-looking bananas.

"I think each of us should keep our share of bananas with us before we begin our fast, so that we don't spend time distributing them after we break our fast. You can imagine how **hungry** we all will be by then!" said the chief's wife.

The monkeys liked the idea and they collected their share of the bananas.

"Why don't we **peel** one banana and keep it ready to eat?" said one of the youngsters.

"Yes, let's do that," **shouted** a fat monkey in agreement. Just looking at the bananas was making him hungry.

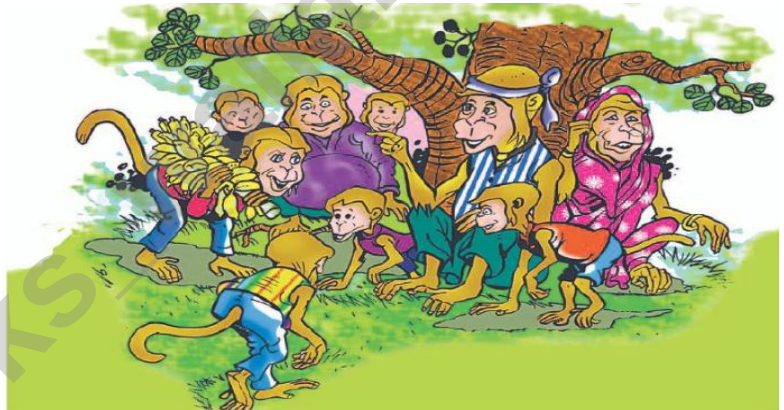
"All right," said the monkey chief. "We shall peel the bananas but under no condition should we eat them."

So the monkeys peeled their bananas and carefully kept them ready for eating in the evening.

"Can I keep the banana in my mouth? I promise not to eat it till evening. Please!" a little monkey asked his father.

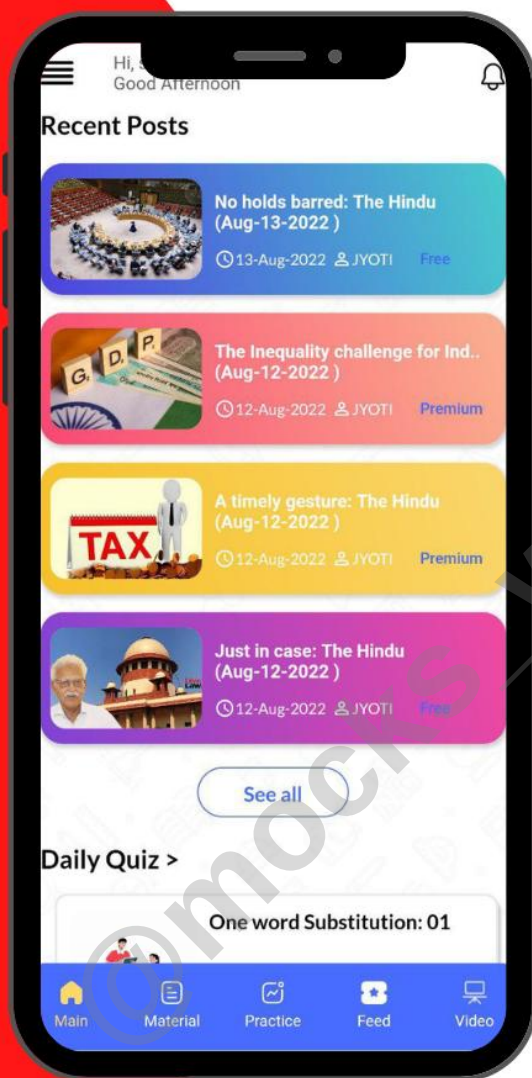
"Why don't we all put a banana in our mouth? That way we can **chew** it immediately when we break the fast," said his father, who had agreed to go on the fast only because his wife had not given him a choice. "**As long as** we don't eat it, it should be fine," he added.

So, the monkeys put the bananas in their mouths. One by one they **eyed** each other uncomfortably as they began their fast — and as you can imagine, within no time at all, the bananas disappeared down their **gullets**. And that was the end of their fast!



Vocabulary

1. **Fast** (noun) – abstinence, self-denial, fasting, restraint, starvation उपवास
2. **Counsel** (verb) – advise, recommend, urge, guide, propose सलाह देना
3. **Nodded one's head** (phrase) – agreed, assented, affirmed, signaled, acknowledged सहमति में सिर हिलाना
4. **In agreement** (phrase) – unanimous, harmonious, consenting, approving, cooperative सहमति में
5. **Hungry** (noun) – starvation, appetite, craving, emptiness, longing भूख
6. **Peel** (verb) – strip, skin, pare, uncover, flay छीलना
7. **Shout** (verb) – yell, scream, exclaim, bellow, holler चिल्लाना
8. **Chew** (verb) – munch, bite, gnaw, chomp, grind चबाना
9. **As long as** (phrase) – provided that, if, on condition that, assuming that, so long as जब तक कि
10. **Eye** (verb) – watch, stare, observe, gaze, scrutinize घूरना
11. **Gullet** (noun) – throat, esophagus, food pipe, gorge, windpipe गला



Learn Vocabulary Through Reading Articles

English Madhyam